

WhatsApp QR Code Clone

Product Requirements Document: Net New Build

Build name: WhatsApp QR Code Clone **Owner:** Chris Wozniak & Nathan Hutton **Date:** June 6, 2026

1. PROBLEM

Small business owners, freelancers, and creators struggle to share their WhatsApp contact and business links instantly in physical settings — at networking events, on printed materials, and in storefronts — because there is no simple standalone tool to generate a WhatsApp-style QR code without navigating through the app itself, resulting in missed connections and lost business opportunities.

Supporting Context:

- WhatsApp has over 2 billion active users globally making it the world's most used messaging platform
 - QR code usage grew 433% between 2021–2025 driven by contactless and mobile-first behavior
 - Most free QR tools are cluttered with ads or require account sign-up before generating a single code
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1a. Opportunity

If we solve this, any small business owner or creator can generate a WhatsApp-style QR code instantly and share it in the physical world — capturing a share of the growing \$2B+ QR code market while serving WhatsApp's massive existing user base who want a simpler way to share their contact link.

Market Opportunity:

- Global QR code market projected to exceed \$2.7B by 2030
 - 89 million US smartphone users scanned a QR code in 2022, up 26% YoY
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1b. Users & Needs

Primary users: Small business owners and freelancers who use WhatsApp for business and need to share their contact link quickly in physical settings without technical knowledge

Secondary users: Event organizers, students, and creators who want to share their WhatsApp profile via printed materials or digital screens

Key User Needs:

- As a small business owner, I need to generate a WhatsApp QR code instantly because I can't expect customers to manually add my number from a flyer or business card
 - As a freelancer, I need a clean downloadable WhatsApp QR code because I print it on business cards and marketing materials
 - As a creator, I need a free tool with no sign-up because I don't want to commit to a platform just to get one QR code
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2. PROPOSED SOLUTION

WhatsApp QR Code Clone is a web tool that replicates WhatsApp's native QR code feature — users enter their phone number or WhatsApp link, and the tool instantly generates a WhatsApp-styled scannable QR code they can download as a PNG. The interface mirrors WhatsApp's visual design with green branding, clean typography, and a familiar card layout. As a result, anyone can create and share a WhatsApp QR code in under 30 seconds — without opening the app.

2a. Value Proposition

Small business owners and creators who use WhatsApp for business use our WhatsApp QR Code Clone, a simple web tool, to generate and download a WhatsApp-style QR code instantly. Unlike navigating through the WhatsApp app settings or using cluttered third-party tools, it works in one click with no sign-up required — delivering a professional, branded QR code in under 30 seconds.

2b. Top 3 MVP Value Props

- **The Vitamin** (must-have baseline): Generate a working, scannable WhatsApp QR code from any phone number or wa.me link instantly
 - **The Painkiller** (solves the core pain): No app navigation, no sign-up, no ads — enter your number and download in one click
 - **The Steroid** (the magic moment): 3 free codes then a seamless freemium upgrade for unlimited generations and custom branding that matches your business identity
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2c. Goals & Non-Goals

Goals:

- Give any user a working WhatsApp-style QR code in under 30 seconds
- Replicate WhatsApp's visual design language — green palette, clean card layout, familiar UI
- Demonstrate a clear and functional freemium gate at 3 free generations with a visible counter at all times
- Make the premium upgrade value obvious without being pushy
- Ship a demo-ready product by end of Cycle 1 Week 1
- Achieve at least 3 successful real-device scans during the live demo that prove the product works in the real world

Non-Goals:

- QR code scan analytics and tracking (deferred to v2)
 - User accounts or login system (out of MVP scope)
 - Real payment processing — upgrade button is mocked for MVP
 - Mobile app — web only for MVP
 - Full WhatsApp Business API integration (out of MVP scope)
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2d. Success Metrics

Goal	Signal	Metric	Target
Real world proof	QR code scanned and opens WhatsApp on a real device	Successful real-device scans	3+ live scans during demo
WhatsApp fidelity	UI matches WhatsApp visual style	Design review by coach	Approved

Freemium awareness	User sees counter before hitting limit	Counter visible from first generation	100% of sessions
Freemium gate	User hits free limit and sees upgrade prompt	Upgrade prompt triggered	100% at 3 generations
Speed	User completes full flow	Time to first QR code	Under 30 seconds
Polish	Judges evaluate product	Demo quality score	4/5 or higher

3. REQUIREMENTS

User Journey 1: User generating a WhatsApp QR code Context: The core user journey — a small business owner needs a WhatsApp QR code fast, with no friction and no sign-up required.

Sub-journey: Generating a QR code

- [P0] User can enter a phone number or WhatsApp wa.me link into an input field
- [P0] User can click a generate button and see a WhatsApp-styled QR code instantly
- [P0] User can download the QR code as a PNG file
- [P0] User can see a generation counter displayed at all times showing remaining free uses (e.g. "2 of 3 free codes used")
- [P0] Generated QR code opens WhatsApp chat when scanned on a real mobile device
- [P1] User can see a live preview of the QR code as they type
- [P2] User can clear the input and start over with one click

Sub-journey: WhatsApp visual experience

- [P0] UI uses WhatsApp green color scheme (#25D366)
- [P0] Layout mirrors WhatsApp's clean card-based QR screen design
- [P0] WhatsApp logo or icon visible in the interface
- [P1] QR code displays with WhatsApp-style framing and branding
- [P2] Animated scan effect to simulate WhatsApp's live QR screen

Sub-journey: Hitting the freemium gate

- [P0] Counter updates visibly after every generation so user always knows where they stand
- [P0] User is blocked from generating a 4th code and shown an upgrade prompt
- [P0] Upgrade prompt clearly explains what premium unlocks
- [P1] Upgrade prompt includes a mock "Upgrade" button with premium feature list
- [P2] User can enter email to simulate unlocking premium tier

Sub-journey: Real world validation

- [P0] Generated QR code must successfully open WhatsApp when scanned by a real mobile device
- [P0] Downloaded PNG must be high enough resolution to scan from a printed page
- [P1] User can test scan directly from the browser before downloading

User Journey 2: Premium user experience Context: A user who has upgraded wants more power and customization beyond the free tier.

Sub-journey: Unlocking premium

- [P0] Premium user can generate unlimited QR codes
 - [P1] Premium user can customize QR code foreground color
 - [P1] Premium user can add a logo or icon to the center of the QR code
 - [P2] Premium user can download in SVG or PDF format in addition to PNG
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4. APPENDIX

Open Questions:

- Should the free generation counter reset daily or be a hard lifetime limit?
- Should we use local state or localStorage to track free usage count?
- How closely should we replicate WhatsApp's exact UI without IP concerns?

Changes Made Based on Peer Feedback:

- Replaced "20+ codes generated" vanity metric with "3+ successful real-device scans" as primary success metric
- Added P0 requirement that generation counter is visible at all times — not just when user hits the limit

Tech Stack:

- Frontend: React or plain HTML/CSS/JS
- QR Library: qrcode.js (free, open source, no API key needed)
- Hosting: VS Code local for MVP, deployable to Vercel
- Color: WhatsApp green #25D366

Competitive Reference:

- WhatsApp native QR code feature (in-app)
- QR Code Generator (qr-code-generator.com)
- QRCode Monkey
- Bitly QR

PRD Owner: Chris Wozniak & Nathan Hutton | Cycle 1 Week 1 | AI-Native L2 Program